



Week 2 Knowledge Check

Strategic Design & Metrics

Technical Product Manager Academy



How This Works

12 questions across the week — the metrics pyramid, the North Star & counter-metric, UX heuristics, AI-assisted research, and journey mapping.

Commit to an answer **before** the reveal. Retrieval is the point.

? Question 1

The Metrics Pyramid has a deliberate shape. Which set of counts, top to bottom, is correct?

- A) Many North Stars, few KPIs, few operational signals
- B) 1 North Star, 2–4 KPIs, 4–10 operational signals
- C) 1 North Star, 10 KPIs, 2–3 operational signals
- D) Equal numbers at every tier

Answer 1 — B

1 North Star, 2–4 KPIs, 4–10 operational signals.

Few at the top, many at the bottom. "A team that has 10 KPIs has 0 KPIs."

? Question 2 — True / False

When a candidate operational signal can't be measured in production today, it's a failure that should be hidden until the data exists.

Answer 2 — False

"We don't measure that today" is not a failure — it's a **finding**.

It's an *instrumentation gap*. Surface it openly; it becomes a Week 4–5 conversation.

? Question 3

The North Star template requires exactly three parts. Which set?

- A) Customer outcome, user segment, single number
- B) Revenue, retention, NPS
- C) Problem, solution, metric
- D) Customer outcome, counter-metric, deadline



Answer 3 — A

Customer outcome / user segment / single number.

Miss any blank and the team fights about which version of the NS they meant. Each blank failing is a different bug.

? Question 4

A counter-metric is best described as:

- A) A backup North Star to use if the first one fails
- B) A second metric that, if it moves the wrong way, signals you're winning the NS for the wrong reasons
- C) A competitor's metric you benchmark yourself against
- D) The KPI that sits directly below the North Star

Answer 4 — B

A second metric that catches winning the NS for the wrong reasons.

The guardrail. Example: hours of dispatcher time returned (NS) paired with % calling support after the new flow (counter-metric) — catches auto-flow that moved time but broke trust.

? Question 5 — True / False

A North Star that lands with leadership but needs translation before it means anything to the customer still qualifies as a defensible North Star.

Answer 5 — False

A defensible NS lands with the CEO **and** the customer **without translation**.

If it only lands with one audience, it's a **KPI in disguise**.

? Question 6

Beyond Nielsen's 10 heuristics, Day 3 adds three TPM-specific lenses. Which set?

- A) Time-to-first-value, failure-mode dignity, power-user respect
- B) Consistency, minimalism, error prevention
- C) Color contrast, focus order, alt text
- D) Severity, frequency, addressability

Answer 6 — A

Time-to-first-value, failure-mode dignity, power-user respect.

The three heuristics designers most often skip early and blame on engineering later. Failure-mode dignity is especially load-bearing for a dispatch tool that runs in trucks with bad signal.

? Question 7 — True / False

The TPM's accessibility responsibility is to personally become the squad's accessibility expert.

Answer 7 — False

The job isn't to be the a11y expert — it's to **refuse to ship a feature that fails the 8-check floor**, and to spot failures unsolicited.

? Question 8

Which request crosses the "bright line" — asking AI to do something it can't do safely?

- A) "Structure these two product-tour transcripts into a comparison matrix"
- B) "Identify 3 questions these materials don't answer"
- C) "What is ServiceTitan's market share?"
- D) "Tell me what's missing relative to my own product"

Answer 8 — C

"What is ServiceTitan's market share?"

AI can summarize and structure source material you provide. It **cannot** tell you what competitors actually do — it will return a confident, plausible, fabricated answer.

? Question 9 — True / False

When cross-validating an AI research summary, the AI's own confidence rating (H/M/L) is a reliable signal of which themes you can trust.

Answer 9 — False

Don't trust the AI's confidence about **its own output**.

Independent citation verification is the only reliable signal. If a citation can't be verified, cut it and lower the theme's confidence.

? Question 10

An AI summary cites "Ticket #4," but no such ticket exists in your pack.
Which summarization failure mode is this?

- A) Theme inflation
- B) Citation invention
- C) Premature confidence
- D) Source bias

Answer 10 — B

Citation invention.

Fix: verify every cited source exists, and demote uncited claims. If 2+ citations are cut from one theme, cut the theme or relabel it "hypothesis to validate."

? Question 11

A feature concept earns a place off the journey map only if it passes all three tests. Which set?

- A) Friction link, metric link, principle link
- B) Cost, schedule, scope
- C) Desirability, feasibility, viability
- D) Severity, frequency, addressability

Answer 11 — A

Friction link, metric link, principle link.

The recurring failure is features with no metric link. Force the link or kill the feature — a feature that moves no signal can't be defended in Week 6.

? Question 12

On a journey map, a friction star on 5+ of the stages most likely means:

- A) The map is thorough and honest
- B) You're not discriminating — re-rank friction by severity
- C) The product is beyond saving
- D) You sanitized the journey and should re-listen to interviews

Answer 12 — B

You're not discriminating — re-rank by severity.

Friction stars should cluster: 2–3 starred stages is a healthy map. If everything is friction, nothing is. (Zero stars means you sanitized it.)



That's Week 2

Score yourself — but the real check is whether you can *use* these when your feature concepts become PRDs on Monday.